

STATE REVIEW LEARNINGS:

ARKANSAS STATE UNIVERSITY

TRADITIONAL

On-Site Review: March 11-12, 2024

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

The report uses evidence from state data collection and an on-site review to examine educator preparation program performance. The information in this report is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

This report rates the EPP on all three Standards of the Arkansas Education Preparation Provider State Review Framework, which are fundamental to support teacher candidates in their journey to becoming successful teachers who meet the needs of students in Arkansas:

- Standard 1, "Candidate Recruitment and Completion," is rated primarily with quantitative data from state data collection.
- For Standard 2, "Preparing Candidates Effectively," criteria to assess performance results from document review, observations, and focus group conversations with stakeholders, including teacher preparation program deans, candidates, current school leaders and teachers, faculty, and the DESE staff.
- The ratings for Standard 3, "Supporting Workforce Needs," are based on state data reporting.

Performance Levels are defined as follows:

Performance Level	Average Score Equivalent
EXCEEDS	Average score equivalent to exceeds on two of three standards or indicators
MEETS	Average score equivalent to meets on all three standards or indicators
APPROACHING	Average score equivalent to approaching on one standard or indicator and meets on the other two
BELOW	Average score equivalent to below on one standard or indicator and approaching on the other two

ARKANSAS STATE UNIVERSITY

TRADITIONAL

Overall Performance Level		
MEETS		
Performance Levels by Standard		
Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion	Standard 2: Preparing Candidates Effectively	Standard 3: Supporting Workforce Needs
MEETS	MEETS	MEETS

STANDARD 1: RECRUITMENT & COMPLETION

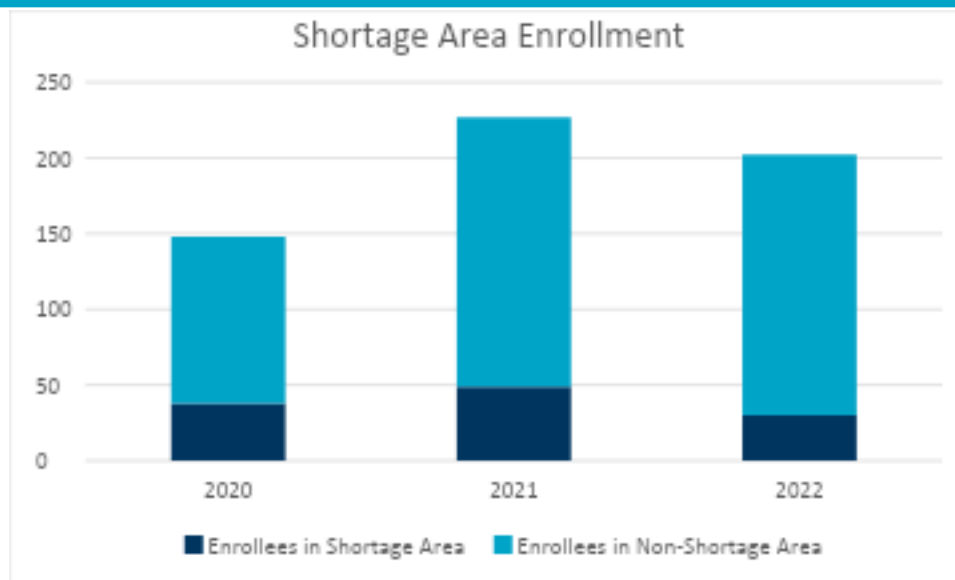
Standard 1 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 1.1 Plans	Indicator 1.2 Recruitment	Indicator 1.3 Completion
MEETS	APPROACHING	EXCEEDS
Recommendations		
Arkansas State University's Traditional undergraduate program enrollment has experienced an average decrease in enrollment after a steady increase from 2017-2019, although those who do enroll successfully complete the program at very high rates. Recruiting additional candidates to increase overall enrollment, and particularly in subject shortage areas, will support the program's Standard 1 performance even more strongly moving forward. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 1.2a and 1.2b)</i>		

INDICATOR 1.1: PLANS

Criteria 1.1a: Programs have formal plans to meet the targets described in the state review framework (i.e., Standards 1-3) and show evidence of acting on their plans	
Performance Level	Explanation
MEETS	EPPs were not asked to submit formal plans to meet the state review framework targets or to show evidence of acting on their plans as part of the Spring 2024 review cycle. As a result, all EPPs in this cycle will receive a rating of MEETS.

INDICATOR 1.2: RECRUITMENT

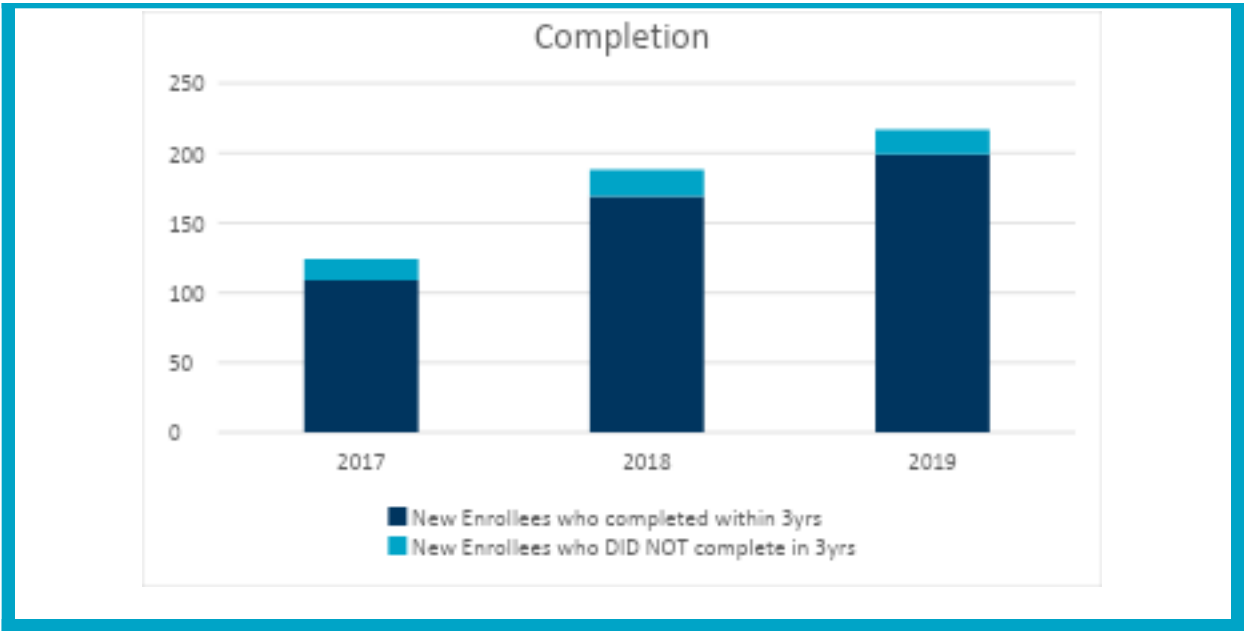
Criteria 1.2a: Programs meet annual recruitment targets* that align with their program size and Arkansas's workforce needs																	
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Growth in 3yr Average Enrollment	Performance Level														
Percentage growth in 3yr average enrollment	10%	-8.7%	APPROACHING														
Enrollment Metric is the percentage growth between blue and green boxes <table><caption>Enrollment Data</caption><thead><tr><th>Year</th><th>Enrollment</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>2017</td><td>125</td></tr><tr><td>2018</td><td>190</td></tr><tr><td>2019</td><td>215</td></tr><tr><td>2020</td><td>130</td></tr><tr><td>2021</td><td>185</td></tr><tr><td>2022</td><td>170</td></tr></tbody></table>				Year	Enrollment	2017	125	2018	190	2019	215	2020	130	2021	185	2022	170
Year	Enrollment																
2017	125																
2018	190																
2019	215																
2020	130																
2021	185																
2022	170																
*The enrollment growth target was established to close the sizeable gap between EPP completers and those leaving the classroom over the next 10yrs. EPPs can earn a "Meets" rating by demonstrating positive program enrollment growth (i.e., growth greater than zero) and an "Exceeds" rating by demonstrating growth greater than 10 percent.																	
Criteria 1.2b: Programs recruit candidates for Arkansas certification shortage areas* in proportion to the need																	
Metric	Target	EPP's Percent of new enrollees in Shortage Areas	Performance Level														
Percentage of program candidates recruited in shortage areas	24%	20%	MEETS														



*Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline), demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased), and state focus areas. Current licensure areas of shortage: Computer Science (4-12), Biology (7-12), Chemistry (7-12), Physics (7-12), Foreign Language (K-12), Math (7-12), Math (4-8), Science (4-8), Special Education (K-12)

INDICATOR 1.3: COMPLETION

Criteria 1.3a: Candidates have high rates of completion			
Metric	Target	EPP's 3-Year Completion Rate	Performance Level
Three-year average completion rate	75%	90%	EXCEEDS



Standard 2: PREPARING CANDIDATES EFFECTIVELY

Standard 2 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 2.1 Coursework	Indicator 2.2 Clinical Experiences	Indicator 2.3 Development
APPROACHING	MEETS	MEETS
Recommendations		
Although it is in its early stages, A-State has developed a transformative plan for its residency model. The governance meetings are collaborative and data-driven. This clear and intentional partnership is a strength at A-State. As the residency grows, collaboration will be essential to support and develop strong teaching candidates and ensure partnerships mutually benefit both EPP and partner districts. Recommendations to strengthen candidate preparation include: • Audit coursework for classroom connections, ensuring that instructors provide models of instruction and clearly and intentionally familiarize candidates with 2023 Arkansas K-12 Standards. This includes providing opportunities to vertically integrate standards throughout all grade bands within their licensure area and ensuring that an increase in coursework rigor is clear to students so they can see how one course builds off another. Clearly and intentionally continue to incorporate HQIM within coursework so that candidates are familiar with the district curriculum and become day one ready. (<i>Focus Areas: Criteria 2.1a Metric 1, Criteria 2.1a Metric 2</i>) • Ensure all candidates have opportunities to reflect on and articulate the alignment of coursework to clinical experience and gain exposure across all grades and subjects across their licensure areas. EPP should standardize the approach to this alignment for all candidates. (<i>Focus Areas: Criteria 2.1b Metric 3, Criteria 2.1c Metric 2</i>) • Formalize systems and structures to ensure that the mentor teachers and clinical supervisors working with candidates in the building are experienced, very effective, and, by the 2026-2027 school year, have received DESE-recognized coaching training. (<i>Focus Areas: Criteria 2.2b</i>) • Standardize the approach for supporting candidates at all performance levels to support retention and track the effectiveness of interventions. (<i>Focus Areas: Criteria 2.3a Metric 2, Criteria 2.3b Metric 4</i>) • A-State should continue planning to meet the state's one-year residency requirement, which will apply to spring 2027 completers and beyond.		

INDICATOR 2.1: COURSEWORK

Criteria 2.1a: Candidates receive high-quality program coursework that is evidence-based
APPROACHING
Metric 1: Incorporation and demonstration of best practices around content instruction
APPROACHING

A-State's traditional route incorporates some nationally recognized best practices around content instruction. Some programs undergo SPA review (Specialized Professional Associations), and their curricula require content knowledge prescribed through those SPA standards. Middle Level, Math, and Social Studies are approved through their Professional Associations. A review of provided course syllabi (ELED 4112, ELED 4122, ELED 4132, MLED 3013) revealed that most courses integrate content-specific best practices. Specific examples were seen by reviewers in MLED 3013 (Literature through Literacy in the Middle Grades) such as book talks, creative book sharing, reading aloud, journals, literature circles, exploratory talks, etc. In one course observation, the professor engaged candidates in a discussion about schools and civic engagement that reflected the C3 (College, Career, and Civic Life) Framework, which serves as the framework for the Arkansas Curriculum Frameworks for Social Studies.

No evidence of HQIM was noted within any of the syllabi. However, a few syllabi reference evaluation and selection of instructional materials with language such as "evaluate evidence-based curricula choices" or "demonstrate proficiency with high-quality text selection." Within the evidence narrative, the program stated: "Currently, HQIM and evaluation of approved materials are being introduced into programs. The university is introducing a new syllabus platform and template implemented in Fall 2024; therefore, syllabi will be revised to reflect new state initiatives." This was corroborated in the course instructor's focus group. HQIMs such as Eureka Math and IReady are mentioned as being utilized in the K12 schools in which teaching candidates are placed for residency and internships; however, the HQIMs have not yet been incorporated into the curriculum.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas K-12 Standards in coursework as a foundation for teacher development
APPROACHING

A-State's traditional programs of study include coursework that somewhat familiarizes candidates with Arkansas K-12 Standards; some licensure pathways provide more opportunities than others. Each traditional program of study includes a methods course that is content-area specific. The syllabi for those courses describe assessments in which candidates must plan lessons aligned to the appropriate Arkansas K-12 State Standards. For example, in ELED 4122, candidates were expected to create and submit an edTPA lesson plan, accompanied by a discussion of how the lesson supports the Arkansas math standards, creates a student-centered environment, and meets the needs of all students.

Additionally, the EdTPA lesson plan used across all programs provides opportunities for candidates to create lessons aligned to the appropriate academic standards. The program reports that "teacher interns in the EPP will experience at least two different grade-level placements between mid-point Field Experience and the Capstone internship, which continues to provide a deeper understanding of the sequence of the standards within the content area."

However, evidence gathered from the Clinical Experience focus group included certain licensure area participants feeling that coursework does not provide sufficient opportunities to practice content for their licensure areas other than in the Science of Reading. They also mentioned that although instructors may encourage them to choose grade levels and subjects that they are less familiar with, this was not enforced. Candidates felt they did not receive exposure to the range of grades and subjects in their licensure area.

The state's Science of Reading requirement meets the awareness level throughout licensure areas with approved programs (e.g. RDNG 3203 for Middle Childhood)

Criteria 2.1b: Candidates' coursework supports their development as a teacher
APPROACHING

Metric 1: Sequence and progression of courses
MEETS

A-State's traditional route includes courses that are clearly and intentionally sequenced across programs of study to build off previous coursework, providing candidates with an opportunity to show proficiency. They also include reinforcement opportunities for candidate growth areas and show a progressive increase in rigor.

A-State provided links to each study program within the traditional route. These programs and their key checkpoints are intentionally scaffolded to ensure candidate readiness as they matriculate through them. Teaching candidates in the Clinical Experience focus group agreed that most courses are clearly and intentionally sequenced across programs of study. They gave examples such as moving from "Foundations" to "Children's Literature," which required knowledge from the previous semester. Another example was moving from "Social Science Field 1" to "Field 2". In "Field 1", they were taught the basics of classroom observations and applied that knowledge in "Field 2".

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in coursework

MEETS

Coursework incorporates Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in a way that develops candidates to meet the knowledge and skills required for their licensure area. Almost all Elementary (BSE) coursework exposes candidates to the Arkansas Educator Competencies, and about one-third of the Secondary coursework does. Course syllabi consistently provide alignment matrices between course competencies and the Arkansas Teaching Standards. The capstone internship experience also addresses all the Arkansas Teaching Standards. While an alignment matrix or crosswalk was not available, the TESS Rubric and the EdTPA rubric used by A-State include competencies that align with the Arkansas Teaching Standards. Performance data on these assessments provide evidence of candidates' proficiency in the ATS.

Metric 3: Alignment of coursework to clinical experience

APPROACHING

Coursework is clearly and intentionally aligned to clinical experience. Throughout the teacher preparation program, teacher candidates have at least three clinical field experiences: an early field experience during their sophomore year, a mid-point during their junior or first semester of their senior year, and a capstone experience during their senior year. Level 1 field experiences are integrated while taking TE 2003, Introduction to Education (K-6, 4-8, and specific K-12 special education and Spanish) and SCED 2513, Introduction to Secondary Teaching (7-12 and K-12). Level 2 field experiences are taken before the capstone internship experience. These field experiences are assigned to courses described in the Undergraduate Bulletin and supervised by the same instructors of the designated courses. Level 3 is the capstone internship experience.

The program cited evidence of candidate preparation for clinical field experiences as course-embedded activities related to TESS and EdTPA. Experiences using those planning tools and competencies familiarize candidates with the expectations for performance during clinical experience activities. For example, course instructors use the EdTPA lesson plan across programs of study. Additionally, all or most courses align course outcomes with TESS. Methods courses provide opportunities for candidates to plan standards-aligned lessons. The residency model provides opportunities for candidates to complete relevant course activities during their concurrent placements and year-round internships.

Candidates have some opportunities to reflect on and articulate the alignment with their clinical supervisor and course instructors. Most internship syllabi include an opportunity for reflection. However, the evidence suggests that the reflection is on the internship itself and does not explicitly connect the learning in the classroom with what is happening in the internship. In another example from a course observation, reviewers found that the material covered was foundational and did not provide opportunities for the teaching candidates to connect the content to clinical experiences. This was a missed opportunity because the coursework covered the topic of classroom assessments.

Criteria 2.1c: Candidates are provided with knowledgeable and effective course instructors

MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of course instructors

MEETS

Most course instructors show deep knowledge of Arkansas K-12 standards, content knowledge, and content pedagogy. A-State meets expectations for this metric. The EPP provided a roster of faculty that describes each individual's credentials, including terminal degrees in their content areas, professional development attendance, PK-12 teaching experience, TESS training, areas of expertise and research, and licenses held. Faculty members are evaluated annually, and A-State provides documentation and samples of coursework feedback. According to A-State's narrative, "the initial programs' instructors' evaluations for fall 2023 range from 3.44 - 5.00, with supporting student statements. The overall mean for the unit was 4.41."

In the Program Director focus group, the participants explained how course instructors are evaluated. They said the dean shares evaluations with low ratings with the department chair to look at areas for improvement. Faculty with coursework are evaluated every term they teach the course, and their department chairs evaluate them yearly.

Reviewers had the opportunity to observe five courses; all five showed evidence of knowledgeable faculty who were well-versed and fluent in their content. In the documentation provided, evaluations that shared student perceptions of faculty effectiveness revealed that 90% agree or strongly agree that their instructor was knowledgeable in their fields of study.

Metric 2: Effectiveness of course instructors

APPROACHING

Overall, reviewers found that some content instructors had strong facilitation and student engagement in course observations. In RDNG 3203 (Foundations of Reading Instruction), the course instructor modeled effective teaching strategies and utilized sample lesson plans. Students were engaged in discussion and writing. However, in other

courses, no evidence was observed of fostering discussion or using questioning strategies to engage students' connection of content to practice.

In the clinical focus group, participants said that feedback from content instructors varied across courses and programs of study. Some coursework focus group participants felt they did not receive enough feedback from most of their instructors. This consensus varied by subject and licensure area. Other candidates felt that their course instructors gave thorough feedback every week.

INDICATOR 2.2: CLINICAL EXPERIENCES

Criteria 2.2a: Candidates are provided clinical experiences throughout their program that support their development as a teacher

APPROACHING

Metric 1: The sequence of clinical experiences

MEETS

The overall sequence of clinical experiences clearly and intentionally builds off previous experiences and includes opportunities for learning and development. Throughout the teacher preparation program, teacher candidates have at least three well-sequenced clinical field experiences: an early field experience during the sophomore year, a mid-point during the junior or first semester senior year, and a capstone experience (8-16 weeks of classroom teaching) during the senior year. Field experiences are coordinated through the Professional Education Programs (PEP) Office and partner school districts.

Metric 2: The variety of clinical experiences

APPROACHING

Various clinical experiences provide adequate opportunities for candidates to work with students with varied learning needs. A-State has categorized its partner school sites based on size and student population. Each teacher intern must complete a field experience from one school in each category, ensuring they are exposed to various school sizes and student populations. In one clinical experience observation, the intern was on a 25/75 split. She spent Monday and Tuesday in the elementary building and Wednesday-Friday at the junior high/high school. The reviewers observed her last day at the elementary school before moving full-time to junior high/high school. In the clinical experience focus group, some candidates had a shortened experience or virtual experience due to COVID-19, and two candidates had an alternative placement during the football season due to their mentor teacher being a coach and unavailable at times.

Some participants felt they had a variety of clinical experiences; however, for others, there seemed to be a disconnect between the clinical experience description and the candidates' experience. Three of the seven participants felt they did not receive enough exposure to classroom teaching before their internship. One participant said they only had two chances to teach for ten minutes each time, and because of that, they did not feel prepared for their internship. Another said they felt like "a helper" in the classroom and only got to teach when they were being evaluated.

Criteria 2.2b: Candidates across the program are provided with an effective clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: The effectiveness of experienced mentor teachers

MEETS

Most experienced mentor teachers are equipped and demonstrate that they have the coaching skills to properly support and develop a candidate's pedagogical development. A-State and the K-12 school-based administrators collaborate to co-select their mentor teachers (whom A-State refers to as "clinical supervisors"). Mentor teachers must hold a degree, preferably a master's degree, hold a valid teaching license in the area where the teacher candidate is being licensed, know the subject matter being taught, and have a minimum of three years of teaching experience.

The mentor teacher must also be able to coach a teacher candidate and positively impact K-12 student learning. These mentors have "effective" and "highly effective" ratings on TESS evaluations. Administrators shared that they select mentor teachers who demonstrate exemplary teacher experience and successfully support the professional growth of teacher candidates. The Mentor Teacher focus group participants confirmed this evidence by citing the same criteria for becoming a mentor. Reviewers also observed evidence of effectiveness in one of the clinical observations. A scripted lesson plan was provided, and they observed the mentor teacher and the intern working collaboratively to develop and execute the lesson. It is evident from the plan and the clinical supervisor's comments that the mentor

teacher was very effective in facilitating the class with the intern. During the lesson, the mentor gave feedback and directives to guide the intern in working with students through their math misconceptions. Afterward, the mentor engaged with the resident, and they debriefed together.

Note: By 2026–2027, evidence that experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents have received DESE-recognized coaching training must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 2: Quality of selection process for experienced mentor teachers

MEETS

The “Teacher Intern Request for Assignment” form documents the name of the selected mentor teacher (A-State refers to as clinical supervisor), grade or subject level teaching, years of experience, highest degree level, and whether the teacher has National Board Certification. All content-area secondary university faculty work closely with the PEP Office to decide to place interns in qualified programs and match teacher candidates to mentor teachers. Principals use their expertise to make the final decisions for placements. Principals in the Partnership focus group corroborated this selection process.

Note: By 2026–2027, evidence that experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents have a minimum 3 years teaching experience, hold a standard Arkansas educators license with a Lead or Master Professional Educator designation, and have evidence of an annual rating of effective or higher in DESE’s Educator Effectiveness System must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 3: Quality of clinical supervisors

MEETS

Most program clinical supervisors (A-State refers to as University Supervisors) have a proven history and show evidence of effective instructional practices and coaching with a positive impact. All clinical supervisors (University Supervisors) have advanced degrees, multiple years of experience, and have attended recent professional development, as evidenced in the documents submitted. Clinical supervisors are evaluated every semester at the end of the capstone semester, and the results are shared with the department chair, dean, and head of the unit.

Metric 4: Quality of feedback to candidates

MEETS

Candidates consistently receive high-quality feedback from their clinical supervisor. Three out of three coaching observations showed evidence of high-quality feedback. Feedback in all three sessions was specific, connected to TESS, and linked to student learning. For example, for the area of the TESS-aligned rubric, the clinical supervisor gave specific examples on how to create feedback forms for the student’s oral presentations, improvements to make to the rubric performance levels for the students, and suggestions to create and share a database of primary and secondary sources for students to use. The feedback was linked to previous feedback. A written report accompanied the oral debrief which was signed and emailed to the intern after their discussion.

Note: By 2024–25, evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use by EPPs must be shown to meet this metric.

Criteria 2.2c: Strong partnerships exist between the EPP and K12 schools and districts that facilitate the development of strong candidates

MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of partnership with districts/schools

MEETS

Strong collaborative processes exist with school districts to co-construct the clinical internship for candidates. Although it is in the early stages, A-State has a residency program that has been co-designed and established with partnership representatives. The Educator Program Advisory Council (EPAC) meets twice yearly to create and review mutually agreeable procedures and policies for continuous improvement. EPAC provides input regarding curriculum, clinical field experiences, and assessment practices among experienced mentor teachers and supervisors. Everyone in the Mentor Teacher focus group agreed that their administration had worked with A-State to prepare and establish the residency. In the Partnership focus group, the participants also shared that there is formal and informal communication with A-State. One principal said their partnership with A-State was over 25 years old and “didn’t know what they would do without A-State’s EPP program.” All the other school partners agreed.

Metric 2: Support and development for clinical supervisors

MEETS

Collaborative processes are in place to support and develop effective clinical supervisors. A-State meets the criteria for this indicator because of the continued support they provide to clinical supervisors. There are required training, orientations, regular meetings, and communications. To ensure quality support and development for supervisors, the PEP Office prepares a "University Supervisor" packet delineating expectations and procedures for supervision. Additionally, all clinical supervisors are recommended to attend the Capstone Internship meetings, which include TESS professional development, coaching training, and edTPA seminars. All new clinical supervisors are required to attend the Orientation meeting. All supervisors have attended the co-teaching training and will have attended the Aspiring Teacher Rubric training sponsored by the DESE before implementation. During each EPP faculty meeting, the director provides resources and updates to clinical supervisors to increase understanding of effective practices.

INDICATOR 2.3: DEVELOPMENT

Criteria 2.3a: Candidates are successful with their program coursework

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate proficiency in coursework

MEETS

Most candidates show proficiency in coursework requirements. To ensure candidates show proficiency in their coursework, A-State has set five checkpoints ranging from admission to graduation, as explained in the "Teacher Education Handbook", which describes each checkpoint in detail. All undergraduate teacher candidates must have a "C" or better in all professional education courses and an overall and content/major GPA of 2.7 or above. Each checkpoint is reviewed by the candidate, their advisor, and the PEP office to maintain retention in the program. Based on the evidence of the uploaded "validations" documents, most candidates meet the program's requirements.

Metric 2: Quality of candidate support across coursework

MEETS

Candidates are provided with an individualized support plan if their coursework requirements are not on track. The "Teacher Handbook" says they are referred to the Program Department Chair and then the Educator Review Committee for intervention and remediation. The committee recommends specific interventions to help the candidate achieve the expected targets and benchmarks.

In the Course Instructor focus group, participants mentioned the option to submit a concern about a student using the Wolfpack system. This system tracks requests for additional help or services at the institutional level. There is a follow-up from the service that communicates with faculty about the steps the candidate and support staff are taking. During the Course Instructor focus group, instructors noted they provide individualized support by reviewing results at the various checkpoints and developing specific improvement plans for students when issues appear during the initial evaluation. Participants from the Course Instructor focus group also gave examples of additional faculty support, including email check-ins, discussion boards with reflective dialogue, and face-to-face Zoom meetings to touch base with students.

Criteria 2.3b: Candidates are successful in their clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate attainment of clinical internship goals and milestones

MEETS

A-State has a set of clear and appropriate goals and milestones for candidates' clinical internships. They have outlined clear milestones for teacher interns to achieve throughout their clinical experiences. Most candidates meet these clinical experience goals and milestones. On the Fall TESS Summative Evaluation, all students are rated 3.1 or above; in the Spring, they are rated an average of 3.5 or above.

Metric 2: Candidate impact on student growth

MEETS

There is adequate evidence that candidates can impact student growth. Interns are expected to complete the edTPA portfolio, which requires them to complete lesson reflections, internalizations, and videotaping in their classroom to

plan, instruct, and assess students to inform instruction. Program Directors cited using TESS and Danielson throughout their programming, which includes components focused on student growth. In Coaching Session observation debriefs, there was evidence of the coach and candidate discussing the importance of student work and exit tickets and how to analyze student data.

Metric 3: Candidate proficiency in effective teaching skills

MEETS

Most candidates are proficient in effective teaching skills, as evidenced in the TESS summative data reports provided by A-State for fall and spring 2023. Most candidates received a rating of “effective” or “highly effective”.

Note: By 2024–25, evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use by EPPs must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 4: Quality of candidate support across clinical internship

APPROACHING

Candidates are somewhat supported in their clinical experience if their development is not on track. The handbook outlines a clear process, and the “Improvement Plan” document details observations, feedback, and next steps. The Program Director focus group explained that the clinical supervisor (mentor teacher) and university supervisor (clinical supervisor) work together to observe and create a plan with a timeline. They inform the intern and sign off on the plan. The intern will have additional supervision for about five days. Then the team meets again to discuss if there has been enough improvement.

However, in the Mentor Teacher focus group, participants shared that there is more support for struggling candidates in the residency model than in the traditional internship. One participant said that mentor teachers do not receive any support in identifying struggling interns or what to do when a struggle arises. Usually, they email the clinical supervisor.

No evidence was provided for identifying high performers except through informal conversations. Although some high-performing residents can substitute in the district or when a mentor teacher is absent, no evidence was provided of intentional opportunities to encourage high-performing candidate retention.

STANDARD 3: SUPPORTING WORKFORCE NEEDS

Standard 3 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 3.1 Licensure	Indicator 3.2 Employment	Indicator 3.3 Effectiveness
APPROACHING	EXCEEDS	MEETS
Recommendations		
A-State's traditional program meets or exceeds nearly all of the State's targets for EPPs to support Arkansas's workforce needs, including first-time Praxis passage rates, EPP Supervisor and Completer perceptions, and completers who become licensed, work in Arkansas public schools and districts (including priority districts and subjects) and stay in the classroom for multiple years. Recommendations include: - Establish programmatic support to ensure that Traditional program completers are prepared to obtain standard licensure. <i>(Focus Area: Criteria 3.1a)</i> - Analyze EPP Completer Supervisor Survey and EPP Completer Survey results to identify and address any areas of improvement related to effectiveness that could lead to higher value-added scores for A-State completers. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 3.3a, 3.3b, and 3.3c)</i>		

INDICATOR 3.1: LICENSURE

Criteria 3.1a: A high proportion of program candidates obtain a standard license			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who have earned a standard license	76%	70%	APPROACHING

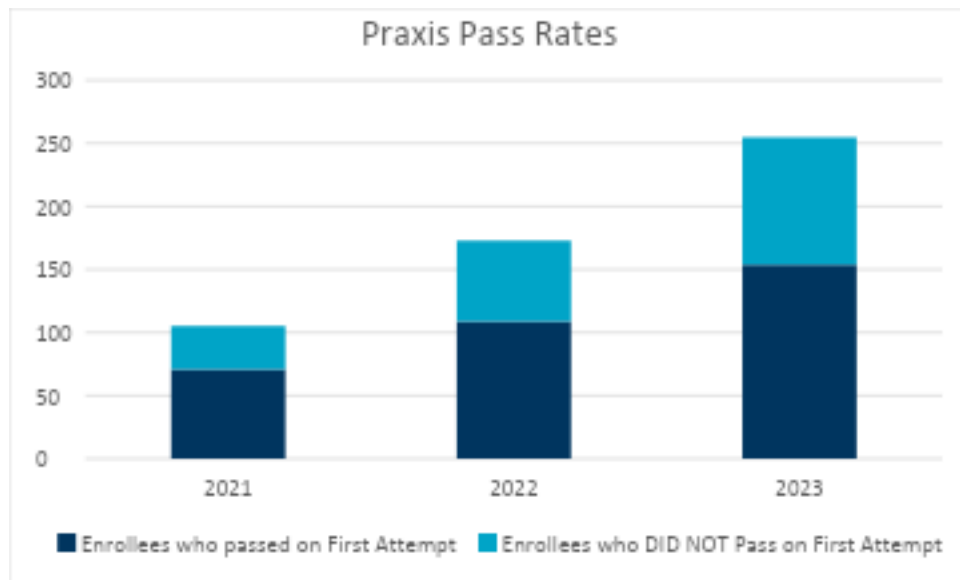


Criteria 3.1b: A high proportion of alternative route enrollees are provisionally licensed

Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of employed alternative route enrollees who are provisionally licensed	69%	n/a	n/a

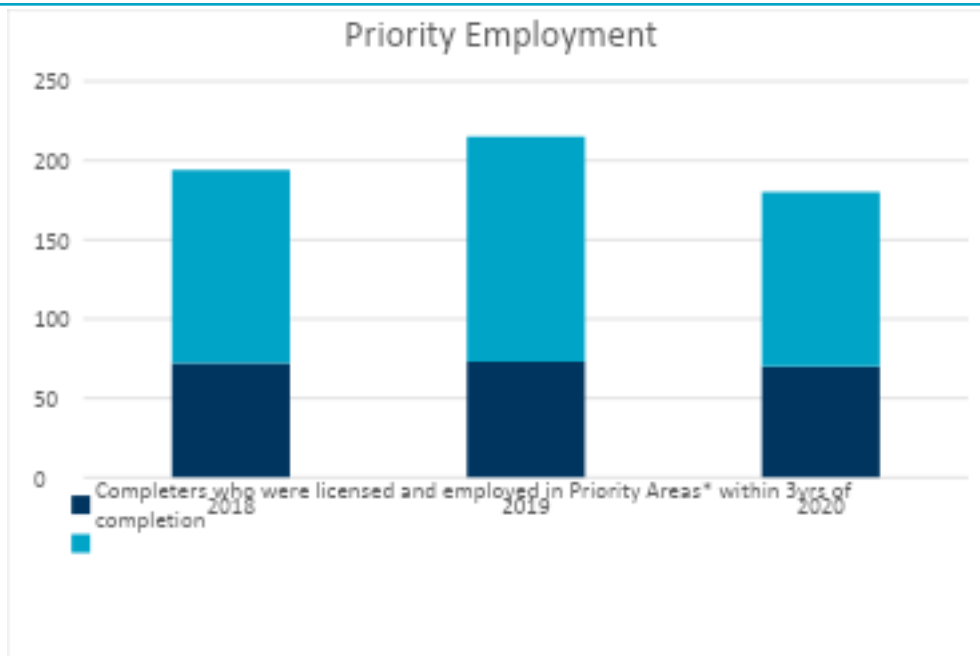
Criteria 3.1c: A high proportion of traditional program candidates pass the content exam in their area on the first try

Metric	Target	EPP's First-Time Pass Percentage	Performance Level
Percentage of first-time licensure exam test takers that pass on their first try	65%	62.7%	MEETS



INDICATOR 3.2: EMPLOYMENT

Criteria 3.2a: A high proportion of completers are employed in Arkansas's public schools																			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed	Performance Level																
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in Arkansas public schools in their first three years after completion	64%	73.3%	EXCEEDS																
Employment <table border="1"> <caption>Employment Data (Approximate Values)</caption> <thead> <tr> <th>Year</th> <th>Completers who were licensed and employed within 3yrs of completion</th> <th>Completers who WERE NOT licensed and employed within 3yrs of completion</th> <th>Total</th> </tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>2018</td> <td>135</td> <td>60</td> <td>195</td> </tr> <tr> <td>2019</td> <td>160</td> <td>55</td> <td>215</td> </tr> <tr> <td>2020</td> <td>140</td> <td>40</td> <td>180</td> </tr> </tbody> </table> ■ Completers who were licensed and employed within 3yrs of completion ■ Completers who WERE NOT licensed and employed within 3yrs of completion				Year	Completers who were licensed and employed within 3yrs of completion	Completers who WERE NOT licensed and employed within 3yrs of completion	Total	2018	135	60	195	2019	160	55	215	2020	140	40	180
Year	Completers who were licensed and employed within 3yrs of completion	Completers who WERE NOT licensed and employed within 3yrs of completion	Total																
2018	135	60	195																
2019	160	55	215																
2020	140	40	180																
Criteria 3.2b: A high proportion of completers work in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects																			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed Priority	Performance Level																
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects in their first three years after completion	40%	36.5%	MEETS																



*Priority Employment is employment in a high-need subject area and/or geographical shortage area. Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline) and demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased) and state focus areas.

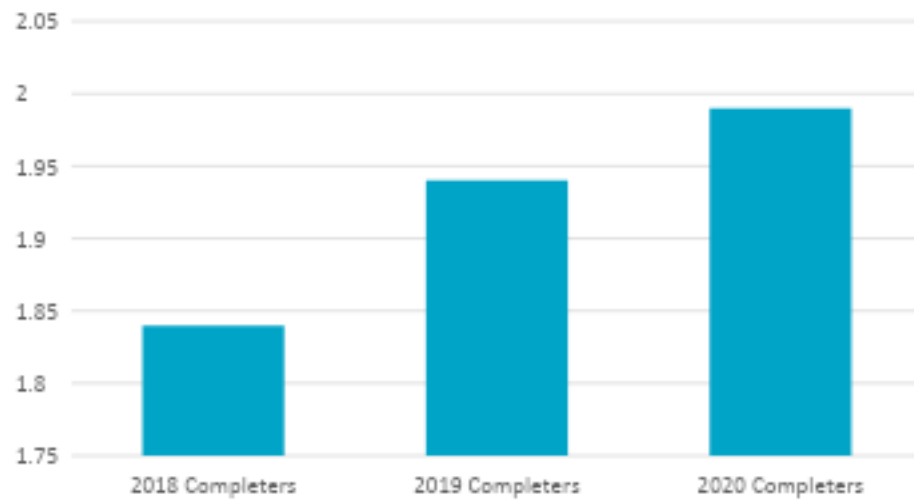
Current subject shortage areas for employment: Computer Science, Secondary Science, Foreign Language, Secondary Math, Middle School Math, Middle School Science, and Special Education.

Current geographical shortage areas are school districts located in the following co-op regions: Arkansas River ESC, Great Rivers ESC, Pulaski Co Schools, Southeast AR ESC.

Criteria 3.2c: Program completers remain in the classroom for multiple years

Metric	Target	EPP's Average Years of Experience, 3 Years After Completion	Performance Level
Program completers' average licensed teaching experience in Arkansas's public schools 3 years after completion	1.7	1.92	EXCEEDS

Average experience three years after completion



INDICATOR 3.3: EFFECTIVENESS

Criteria 3.3a: School leaders rate program completers that they hire as effective classroom teachers			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
School leaders' perception of program completer effectiveness based on responses to the EPP Completer Supervisor Survey conducted annually by DESE	81%	78.8%	MEETS
Criteria 3.3b: Completers feel that their program prepared them well to be a teacher			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
Program completers' perception of how well their program prepared them to be a teacher based on responses to the EPP Completer Survey conducted annually by DESE	75%	78.5%	EXCEEDS
Criteria 3.3c: A high proportion of program completers have above-average value-added scores			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage with Average Value-Added of 80+	Performance Level
Percentage of program completers who have above-average value-added scores in their first three years after completion	43%	35%	APPROACHING

